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UAE CELEBRATES THE FESTIVAL OF LIGHTS

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan and His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, extended their best wishes to everyone celebrating Diwali in the UAE and around the world. The UAE celebrated Diwali with a packed programme of cultural events, live performances, Indian food and family entertainment. Seen here is the Deepavali Utsav at Amity School, organised by the Consulate General of Dubai. **SEE ALSO P4, 12, P-II, PII**

ABU DHABI

Corniche's evolution from quiet shores to a modern waterfront | P IV



IN FOCUS

The 30-day Dubai Fitness Challenge grips city, inspires residents to get fitter | P8-9



UAE's foreign trade nears Dh3 trillion

EXPORTS TO 10 LARGEST TRADING PARTNERS SURGE 31%

DUBAI

BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

The UAE's foreign trade approached a record Dh3 trillion for the first time in the first nine months of 2026, marking a 10 per cent increase compared with the same period last year, His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, announced yesterday.

In a post on his X account, Sheikh Mohammed said he had reviewed the UAE's foreign trade report for the first nine months of the year, which also showed a 31 per cent increase in exports to the country's 10 largest trading partners compared with the previous year.

Major hub for international trade

The figures underscore the UAE's continued role as a major hub for international trade despite economic and political challenges and shifts in global trade patterns.

> **In a year marked by numerous economic and political challenges and shifts in global trade, the UAE remains a major hub for international trade. It continues to respond with flexibility and efficiency to all the changes around it."**
>
> **Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum**

Sheikh Mohammed said: "In a year marked by numerous economic and political challenges and shifts in global trade, the UAE remains a major hub for international trade. It continues to respond with flexibility and efficiency to all the changes around it, strengthen its network of international relations, expand its export markets and chart its own distinctive path towards accelerated and sustainable economic growth."

Strengthening international partnerships

Sheikh Mohammed highlighted the country's ability to respond flexibly and efficiently to changing global conditions while continuing to strengthen its international partnerships and expand its export markets.

The UAE, he added, remains committed to pursuing its distinctive path of accelerated and sustainable economic growth.

Sheikh Mohammed congratulated President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, all national teams involved in achieving the milestone, and the UAE's partners who had placed their confidence in the country's success.

"This is an achievement for which we congratulate the UAE President, all our national teams and our partners who placed their confidence in our success," the Vice-President added.



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